

Transforming Certification for Better Care

ABMS CONFERENCE 2026

Article-Based Assessment in Continuing Certification

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Disclosure

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What is article-based assessment?

- **Purpose**

- Maintain current knowledge
- Connect evidence to practice
- Promote learning through assessment

- **Format**

- Uses current, clinically relevant, peer-reviewed literature as the foundation for assessment
- Evaluates understanding and application of scientific evidence in clinical decision-making
- Provides feedback that reinforces key learning points

Article-based assessment models across ABMS member boards

Article-based learning	Article-enhanced longitudinal assessment	Article-based continuing certification assessment
ABO	ABA	ABPN
ABOG	ABAI	
	ABCRS	
	ABEM	

ABO: Quarterly Questions

- **Article:** “Must-read” literature curated by ophthalmologists representing the major subspecialty societies. 70 articles across 22 subject areas were available via platform in 2026.
- **Assessment:** Two questions per article, with two attempts per question.
- **Scoring:** Article-based questions do not count toward overall score or pass/fail decisions; Completing 10 article-based questions with at least 80% correct each quarter earns CME credit.
- **Learning support:** A “key point” explaining the required knowledge and the reason why the correct answer is the best choice is provided after answer submission.
- Source: [Quarterly Questions - ABO Continuing Certification - 1](#)

ABOG: Article-based Assessments

- **Article:** Approximately 85 articles are available annually in two releases, January and May. Publishers determine whether articles are available at no cost or require purchase.
- **Assessment:** Reading assignments are tailored to specialty or subspecialty. 10 articles, 6 questions each (60 total)
- **Scoring:** Meet the 80% Part II article-based assessment threshold; an average of 86% through CC years 1-5 to be exempt from taking a secure written exam
- source: [Part II: Lifelong Learning & Self-Assessment](#)

ABA: Article-based MOCA Minute questions

- **Program:** An 18-month pilot from July 2025 to December 2026
- **Article:** Anesthesiology journal editors select articles relevant to clinical practice
- **Assessment:** Diplomates receive three “Anesthesiology” articles each quarter, and up to three questions related to these articles will appear in that quarter’s MOCA Minute.
- **Scoring:** Contribute to diplomates’ MDT value the same way as all other MOCA Minute questions
- Source: [MOCA Minute Article-Based Question - The American Board of Anesthesiology](#)

ABAI: Article-based questions for Continuous Assessment Program

- **Article:** For each six-month block, 3-5 articles for each of 9 main categories are made available (~35 articles per block). All diplomates have access to most featured articles.
- **Assessment:** Each article has 3-5 questions. Diplomates are required to choose 10 articles, and three questions are randomly administered for each selected article, with 10 minutes for each question.
- **Scoring:** A total of 40 questions (30 article-based questions and 10 core questions) every 6 months and score 80% or higher at the end of 5-year cycle
- Source: [American Board of Allergy and Immunology: Frequently Asked Questions \(FAQs\) for Continuous Assessment Program \(CAP\)](#)

ABCRS: Article-based assessment (CertLink)

- **Article:** One to three articles are used in Q1 and Q3 each year.
- **Assessment:** Approximately 12 questions are delivered each quarter via CertLink.
- **Scoring:** Complete 16 consecutive quarters with 70% correct for a 5-year cycle
- Source: [Part III: CertLink – ABCRS](#)

Summary

Key design choices vary across implementation models:

- How articles are curated and accessed
- How many articles and questions are required
- How performance is scored and “passing standard” is defined



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